

LEAN-BULK TRAINING PLAN

BUILT FOR LUKE · PUSH / PULL / LEGS / REST (ROLLING 4-DAY) · GOAL: BUILD MUSCLE, STAY LEAN

BODYWEIGHT
~165 lb

HEIGHT
6'0"

TARGET
175-180 lb · slow

SURPLUS
+0.25-0.5 lb/wk

PRIORITY
Recovery first

THE SPLIT & WHY

Run it rolling: **Push → Pull → Legs → Rest**, then repeat. Each muscle gets trained about every 4 days (~1.75x/week) with a real rest day baked into every cycle. The rest day drifts across the calendar — that's fine. Train 3, rest 1, on loop.

On a lean bulk the surplus is small, so **recovery — not effort — caps your growth**. Every session is 5-6 focused lifts plus a short core finisher, so you build progressable stimulus instead of junk volume you can't recover from or beat next week. This is a **year-long build**: slow scale climb, lifts up every week, then a focused 6-8 week cut once you reach 175-180.

WHAT'S NEW IN V2

- **Core added where it fits**: cable crunch on Push, hanging leg raise on Pull — kept off Legs since squats + RDLs already tax your core and lower back.
- **Back & quad volume trimmed** into the efficient zone (you were running ~21-24 sets/wk on each — diminishing returns + extra fatigue). Same growth, less wear.
- **Squat set to your current 80 kg working weight** — climb from here with the progression rules below.

DAY 1 PUSH				CHEST · SHOULDERS · TRICEPS · CORE
EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	START	
Barbell flat bench	4 × 5-8	3 min	70 kg	
Standing barbell OHP	3 × 6-8	2.5 min	45 kg	
Incline DB press (30°)	3 × 8-12	2 min	30 kg ea	
DB lateral raise	3 × 12-15	75 sec	12.5 kg	
Rope pushdown	3 × 10-12	75 sec	27.5 kg	
Overhead cable triceps (optional)	2-3 × 12-15	60 sec	22.5 kg	
Cable crunch CORE	3 × 10-15	60 sec	32.5 kg	

DAY 2

PULL

BACK · REAR DELTS · BICEPS · CORE

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	START
Weighted pull-ups	3 × 6-8	3 min	+7.5 kg
Barbell row	3 × 6-8	3 min	70 kg
Lat pulldown (wide)	3 × 10-12	2 min	60 kg
Chest-supported DB row (optional)	2 × 10-12	90 sec	20 kg ea
Barbell curl	3 × 8-10	75 sec	35 kg
Face pull	3 × 15	60 sec	20 kg
Hammer curl (optional)	2 × 10-12	60 sec	22.5 kg
Hanging leg raise CORE	3 × 8-12	60 sec	bodyweight

DAY 3

LEGS

QUADS · HAMS · GLUTES · CALVES

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	REST	START
Barbell back squat	4 × 5-8	3 min	80 kg
Romanian deadlift	3 × 8-10	2.5 min	60 kg
Leg press	3 × 10-12	2 min	120 kg
Bulgarian split squat	2 × 10-12 / leg	90 sec	20 kg ea
Seated leg curl	3 × 10-12	75 sec	45 kg
Leg extension (optional)	2 × 12-15	60 sec	42.5 kg
Standing calf raise	3 × 12-15	60 sec	pick 12RM

DAY 4

REST

RECOVER · SLEEP · REPEAT

Full rest, or easy recovery only. Optional 30-45 min Z2 (easy bike or walk, nose-breathing pace) plus 10 min mobility or sauna if you want it. **Sleep is the real session here** — aim 7.5-9 h. Then loop back to Push.

HOW TO PROGRESS – DOUBLE PROGRESSION

- **Beat the log every session** — one more rep or a touch more weight on at least one set. Log every working set.
- **Add reps first.** Stay at the same weight until you hit the top of the range across all sets.
- **Then add weight** (+2.5 kg upper, +5 kg lower) and reset to the bottom. Repeat for months.
- **Leave reps in the tank:** ~2–3 RIR on compounds, ~0–1 on isolation/machines. Full ROM. Cheated reps aren't progress.
- **Judge over weeks**, not single days.

RECOVERY & AUTOREGULATION

- **Show up beat up?** Keep the weights, cut 1–2 sets per lift, stay 2–3 from failure. A trimmed session still counts.
- **Truly wrecked?** Take the rest day early — that's autoregulation, not failure.
- **Real warning sign** = lifts stalling/going backward across several sessions. If so, pull volume back, don't add.
- **Sleep is lever #1.** 7.5–9 h beats any supplement or extra set.
- **Don't bolt on exercises.** Too easy? Add reps or weight, not volume.

WEEKLY VOLUME MAP — fractional sets/week, tuned to the efficient zone

MUSCLE	SETS / WEEK	ZONE	READ
Back	~17	EFFICIENT	Trimmed from ~24 — better return per set
Quads	~17	EFFICIENT	Trimmed from ~21
Chest	~12	EFFICIENT	Dialed
Biceps	~12	EFFICIENT	Direct + indirect from all pulling
Triceps	~11	EFFICIENT	Direct + indirect from pressing
Shoulders	~10	EFFICIENT	Side delts ~5 — add a set if you want them bigger
Hamstrings	~10	EFFICIENT	Dialed
Abs	~6	EFFICIENT	New core finishers, 2×/wk
Calves	~5	MIN EFFECTIVE	Efficient dose — add only if a priority

Principle (Pelland et al.): growth keeps rising with volume but each added set returns less. ~8–18 sets/muscle is the high-efficiency band; past ~19 you pay a lot of fatigue for a little extra. Within that band, getting close to failure + beating the log matters far more than the exact number.

NUTRITION ANCHORS — lean bulk

DAY	CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
Training day	~3,100	180–200 g	~400 g	~80 g
Rest day	~2,600	180–200 g	~300 g	~75 g

- **Protein is the number you actually hit.** Cluster most carbs around training; park fat in the non-training meals.
- **Fuel the session:** 40–60 g fast carbs ~30–45 min pre-lift — biggest lever on how a workout feels, more than caffeine.
- **Scale rule:** weigh each morning, judge only the weekly average. Want +0.25–0.5 lb/wk. Climbing >0.75/wk → trim training cals ~150. Stalled 2–3 wks → add ~150.
- **Creatine** 5 g/day, every day — cheapest, most proven size & strength supplement. No timing needed.
- **Track it:** log every set, a progress photo every 4 weeks, weekly weight average. Day-to-day is noise; the month is the truth.

THE YEAR

Show up, beat last week's log, eat enough, sleep, and let consistency do the work. **Lifts climbing + scale creeping ≈ 0.3–0.4 lb/week = it's working.** Don't bail to a cut when the scale jumps or a session feels flat — that's the loop that's reset you before. Build now, reveal later.